the whole day. At least keeping the vibe going adds a little to the experience.

Not that this is a Chargers issue only. A couple of my national teammates are also a little too quiet on the field for my liking. My old friend Jacques Kallis doesn't say much when he's fielding – he's probably the quietest one on the field. That's just his nature, I guess. I asked him once why he doesn't say anything on the pitch. And he didn't say anything.

I often get asked if I regret not achieving the 100 Test-cap mark. Well, even though I haven't officially retired from Test cricket and I'm still contracted to the UCB, I do know that my Test cricket career is pretty much over. Maybe some part of me is disappointed. I got close – I have 90 Tests to my name – but to be honest, I'm not really too bothered. After all, I had a little over 11 great years from November 1996 to January 2008.

If I have to be frank, I didn't really justify my place in the Test team in 2008. The selectors did the right thing to drop me. I probably had my best years in Test cricket as an opener between 2001 and 2005 – at one stage, my average was up to 51. Unfortunately the rot set in when I moved down the order. I became really inconsistent. After I went back to opening, I didn't make any runs. The last Test century I scored was back in 2005, when I hit 161 off England at the Wanderers. So, ja, I have no complaints about being dropped, really. I had a good-enough run.

Funny, I'd always thought I would be the first black or coloured player to reach the 100-Test milestone, but it was not to be. In those 11 or so years I reckon I probably missed about six or seven Tests through injuries, so I could've got even closer. Still, compared to most other players, I had a lot of injury-free time, so it's not a big deal. A hundred Tests would have been nice, but it's not the end of the world not making it – after all, 90 Tests is still 90 Tests. In my Test career, I scored 6 167 runs at an average of 41.95, with 14 centuries and 26 fifties. That's still an achievement of which to be proud.

The one milestone I am genuinely disappointed not to have achieved was scoring 250 runs in a Test. That score was on the cards for me in the second Test against Pakistan in 2003. We were playing at Newlands, and all was going well for me until I was given out, caught at silly point by Younis Khan off Saqlain Mushtaq's bowling. My bat had been nowhere near the ball. Man, I was pissed off. I know 'ifs' and 'buts' mean nothing, 'but' I got a shocker of a decision from umpire Srinivas Venkataraghavan. To be given